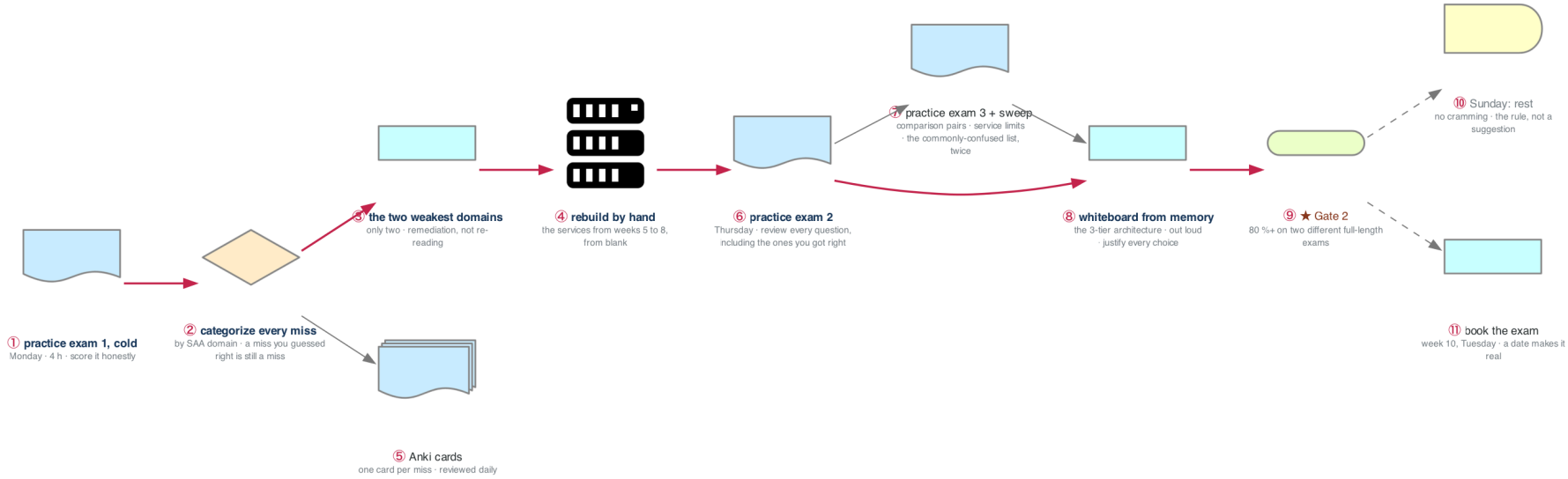
The consolidation loop that produces an 80 percent, numbered

Week 9 · Figure 9.1 · figure with badges 1–11 · 2026-10-17



What to say, badge by badge

About three minutes at a normal pace (339 words). Point at each badge as you say its line.

▶ **Open**
“This is the only week where exam prep is allowed to dominate, and it is one week on purpose. The picture is a loop, not a reading list: measure, find the two weak spots, rebuild them with your hands, measure again.”

1 **practice exam 1, cold**
“Monday morning, no review first. The point is a true baseline. Score it, and write the score down before you rationalize it.”

2 **categorize every miss**
“Every wrong answer goes into a domain bucket. So does every right answer you were not sure of. A guess that landed is a gap you have not seen yet.”

3 **the two weakest domains**
“Two, not five. Remediation spread across everything is re-reading, and re-reading feels like progress without being any.”

4 **rebuild by hand**
“For those two domains, build the services again from a blank console or CLI, the way you did in weeks 5 to 8. The exam asks what a thing is for; building it is how you remember.”

5 **Anki cards**
“One card per miss, in your own words, reviewed every day for the rest of the program. The exam is in nine days; the cards outlast it.”

6 **practice exam 2**
“Thursday. Different provider from Monday if you can. Review every question, including the ones you got right, because the explanation is where the comparisons live.”

7 **practice exam 3 and the sweep**
“Friday: a third exam plus the comparison pairs and the service limits. The commonly-confused-services guide is read twice this week because the exam is built from it.”

8 **whiteboard from memory**
“Saturday: draw the month-2 three-tier architecture with nothing open, out loud, and say why each choice is there. This is what the exam measures underneath the multiple choice.”

9 **Gate 2**
“Eighty percent or better on two different full-length exams. Not one. If you are under, move the exam; a two-week slip costs less than a failed attempt.”

10 **Sunday rest**
“No cramming. Fatigue costs more points than one more practice exam gains. The rule is written down because everyone breaks it.”

11 **book the exam**
“A booked date is what turns prep into a deadline. Week 10, Tuesday.”

■ **Close**
“Measure, narrow, rebuild, measure again. Then one more week and back to building, because certification that displaces building is how this whole program fails.”